

The study of mechanical or 'formal' reasoning began with philosophers and mathematicians in antiquity. The study of logic led directly to Alan Turing's theory of computation, which suggested that a machine, by shuffling symbols as simple as '0' and '1', could simulate both mathematical deduction and formal reasoning, which is known as the Church–Turing thesis. This, along with concurrent discoveries in cybernetics and information theory, led researchers to consider the possibility of building an 'electronic brain'. The first paper later recognized as 'AI' was McCulloch and Pitts design for Turing-complete 'artificial neurons' in 1943. The field of AI research was founded at a workshop at Dartmouth College in 1956.